

ParaPro

High-Yield 30

30 High-Yield Questions Based on the Skills ParaPro Candidates Ask About Most

Weighted to the Real Exam Blueprint • Full Answer Explanations

Exclusive bonus for readers of the ParaPro Assessment Study Guide

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ParaPro High-Yield 30

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Exam Success Academy

How This Bonus Was Built

These 30 questions are not a random sample. They are weighted to approximate the real ParaPro Assessment section proportions: the official test splits its 90 questions evenly across Reading, Mathematics, and Writing, so this bonus mirrors that with 10 questions in each section.

Within each section, the question types reflect what the real ParaPro tests most: vocabulary in context and main idea in Reading, fractions/percent/ratio word problems in Mathematics, and grammar and mechanics in Writing — plus the classroom-application items (a paraeducator observing and helping a student) that make up roughly a third of the real exam.

Every question below includes a full explanation: why the correct answer is right, and why each of the other choices is wrong. That second part is what most practice sets skip — and it's usually where the actual learning happens.

Reading

Question 1 | Main Idea

Passage: Ms. Ortiz noticed that during independent reading time, several students kept asking her to define words instead of trying to figure them out first. She began asking, “What do you think it means? What clues does the sentence give you?” before offering the definition herself. Within a few weeks, more students started using context clues on their own before asking for help.

What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Ms. Ortiz stopped helping students with vocabulary.
- B. Students should never ask a teacher for help.
- C. Independent reading time was removed from the schedule.
- D. Ms. Ortiz taught students to use context clues before asking for help.

Correct Answer: D

The passage shows Ms. Ortiz shifting her approach — asking guiding questions about context clues before giving definitions — which led students to try that strategy on their own. That shift is the passage's main idea. Choice A misstates what happened: she still helped, just differently. Choice B overgeneralizes a specific teaching strategy into an absolute rule the passage never states. Choice C introduces a detail that never appears in the passage.

Question 2 | Vocabulary in Context

(Refers to the same passage as the question above.)

As used in the passage, “context clues” most nearly means:

- A. rules for correct spelling
- B. hints in the surrounding text that suggest a word's meaning
- C. a list of vocabulary words to memorize
- D. the definition printed in a dictionary

Correct Answer: B

“Context clues” refers to hints within the surrounding sentence or passage that help a reader figure out an unfamiliar word's meaning — exactly what Ms. Ortiz was prompting students to notice (“What clues does the sentence give you?”). Choice A confuses context clues with spelling rules, an unrelated skill. Choice C describes a vocabulary list, not a reading strategy. Choice D describes a dictionary definition, which is the opposite of figuring a word out independently from context.

Question 3 | Main Idea

Passage: A classroom library was organized by reading level, but many students always picked the same few books from the shelf. The paraeducator added a rotating display of new titles at students' eye level each Monday. Within a month, checkout records showed a wider variety of books being borrowed than before.

What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. A weekly rotating book display led students to borrow a wider variety of books.

- B. Reading levels were removed from the classroom library.
- C. Students refused to read any books from the shelf.
- D. The library was moved to a new location in the school.

Correct Answer: A

The passage describes a specific change (a rotating display of new titles) and its measured effect (a wider variety of books borrowed) — that cause-and-effect relationship is the main idea. Choice B is not supported; the passage never says reading levels were removed. Choice C contradicts the passage, which says students did pick books, just a narrow set at first. Choice D introduces a detail never mentioned.

Question 4 | Supporting Evidence

(Refers to the same passage as the question above.)

Which detail from the passage best supports the idea that the display was effective?

- A. The library was organized by reading level.
- B. Students always picked the same few books.
- C. Checkout records showed a wider variety of books borrowed.
- D. The display was placed at students' eye level.

Correct Answer: C

The checkout records showing a wider variety of borrowed books are the direct evidence the passage gives that the change worked. Choice A describes the library's original organization, not evidence of the display's effect. Choice B describes the problem before the change, not evidence that the solution worked. Choice D describes a detail of how the display was set up, not evidence of its outcome.

Question 5 | Vocabulary in Context

In the sentence “The teacher's instructions were concise, so the students finished quickly,” the word “concise” most nearly means:

- A. confusing
- B. written in a foreign language
- C. repeated several times
- D. brief and clear

Correct Answer: D

“Concise” means expressed in few words, clearly and briefly — consistent with instructions that let students finish quickly. Choice A is close to the opposite; confusing instructions would likely slow students down, not speed them up. Choice B introduces a meaning unrelated to “concise.” Choice C is also nearly opposite — repeated instructions would take longer, not less time.

Question 6 | Vocabulary in Context

In the sentence “The librarian's approach to organizing the shelves was methodical, following the same careful steps every time,” the word “methodical” most nearly means:

- A. done in an orderly, systematic way
- B. careless and random
- C. done only once
- D. based on guessing

Correct Answer: A

“Methodical” describes an orderly, systematic way of doing something, matching “following the same careful steps every time.” Choice B is the opposite of methodical. Choice C misreads “every time” in the sentence, which indicates repetition, not a single occurrence. Choice D contradicts the idea of following careful, deliberate steps.

Question 7 | Instructional Application

A paraeducator notices that a student can read most words on a page correctly but cannot explain what the passage was about afterward. Which strategy would best address this specific difficulty?

- A. Have the student reread the passage more quickly.
- B. Pause after each paragraph and ask the student to summarize what happened.
- C. Assign a longer, more difficult passage instead.
- D. Have the student skip the passage and move to vocabulary flashcards.

Correct Answer: B

The student's difficulty is with comprehension, not word recognition, so pausing to summarize builds the specific skill of tracking meaning while reading. Choice A addresses speed, not comprehension, and would not target the actual problem. Choice C increases difficulty without addressing the comprehension gap, likely making the problem worse. Choice D avoids the passage entirely and shifts to an unrelated skill, not the comprehension strategy the student needs.

Question 8 | Instructional Application

A student consistently mispronounces multisyllabic words by guessing based on the first letter alone. Which approach would most directly help the student improve?

- A. Tell the student the correct pronunciation each time without further instruction.
- B. Have the student avoid multisyllabic words in future reading.
- C. Ask the student to read the word ten times in a row.
- D. Teach the student to break the word into smaller syllable chunks and sound out each part.

Correct Answer: D

Breaking words into syllable chunks directly targets the student's specific error (guessing from the first letter) by teaching a decoding strategy for the whole word. Choice A provides the answer but does not teach a transferable skill the student can use independently next time. Choice B avoids the problem rather than building the skill needed to solve it. Choice C (repetition without a new strategy) does not address the underlying decoding error.

Question 9 | Main Idea

Passage: Before the class field trip, the teacher reviewed the schedule three times and posted it on the board. On the day of the trip, only two students asked what time the bus would leave. The teacher noted this was far fewer questions than in previous years, when the schedule had only been announced once verbally.

What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Field trips should be canceled if students ask too many questions.
- B. The bus was late on the day of the field trip.
- C. Reviewing the schedule multiple times and posting it reduced the number of students' questions.
- D. Students are not interested in field trip schedules.

Correct Answer: C

The passage links the repeated, posted schedule to a measurable drop in questions compared to previous years — that connection is the main idea. Choice A is not supported; the passage never suggests canceling trips. Choice B introduces a detail never mentioned. Choice D contradicts the passage, since students did ask about the schedule, just fewer of them.

Question 10 | Inference

(Refers to the same passage as the question above.)

Based on the passage, what can be reasonably inferred about how the schedule was communicated in previous years?

- A. It was announced only once and not posted, unlike this year.
- B. It was posted on the board multiple times, just like this year.
- C. It was never communicated to students at all.
- D. It was sent home in a letter to parents only.

Correct Answer: A

The passage directly contrasts this year's approach ("reviewed... three times and posted") with previous years, when "the schedule had only been announced once verbally" — meaning it was not posted and was communicated only a single time. Choice B contradicts the direct contrast the passage draws. Choice C goes further than the passage supports; it says the schedule was announced, just less thoroughly. Choice D introduces a method the passage never mentions.

Mathematics

Question 11 | Fractions

A recipe calls for $\frac{2}{3}$ cup of sugar. If the recipe is doubled, how much sugar is needed?

- A. $\frac{1}{3}$ cup
- B. $\frac{4}{3}$ cup
- C. $\frac{4}{6}$ cup
- D. 2 cups

Correct Answer: B

Doubling $\frac{2}{3}$ gives $\frac{2}{3} \times 2 = \frac{4}{3}$ cup (1 $\frac{1}{3}$ cups). Choice A results from halving the amount instead of doubling it. Choice C results from the common error of adding the numerators and denominators separately ($2+2=4$, $3+3=6$) instead of multiplying the numerator only. Choice D results from tripling the amount instead of doubling it: $\frac{2}{3} \times 3 = 2$.

Question 12 | Percent

A paraeducator scored 42 out of 50 points on a training quiz. What percent did the paraeducator score?

- A. 70%
- B. 80%
- C. 84%
- D. 92%

Correct Answer: C

$\frac{42}{50} = 0.84 = 84\%$. Choice A results from misreading the total as 60 instead of 50: $\frac{42}{60} = 70\%$. Choice B results from misreading the score as 40 instead of 42: $\frac{40}{50} = 80\%$. Choice D results from subtracting the missed points from 100 without converting them to a percent of 50 first: $100 - (50 - 42) = 100 - 8 = 92$.

Question 13 | Decimals

A paraeducator has \$18.75 and spends \$6.40 on classroom supplies. How much money is left?

- A. \$12.35
- B. \$11.35
- C. \$12.45
- D. \$25.15

Correct Answer: A

$\$18.75 - \$6.40 = \$12.35$. Choice B results from subtracting \$7.40 instead of \$6.40, a \$1 misread of the amount spent: $\$18.75 - \$7.40 = \$11.35$. Choice C results from misreading \$6.40 as \$6.30: $\$18.75 - \$6.30 = \$12.45$. Choice D results from adding the amount spent instead of subtracting it: $\$18.75 + \$6.40 = \$25.15$.

Question 14 | Algebra

Solve for x: $2x + 5 = 17$

- A. 10
- B. 11
- C. 12
- D. 6

Correct Answer: D

Subtracting 5 from both sides gives $2x=12$; dividing by 2 gives $x=6$. Choice A results from subtracting the coefficient (2) from 12 instead of dividing by it: $12-2=10$. Choice B results from adding 5 to 17 instead of subtracting it: $2x=22$, $x=11$. Choice C is the value of $2x$ itself ($17-5=12$), mistakenly left un-divided by 2.

Question 15 | Geometry

A rectangular classroom rug measures 6 feet by 4 feet. What is its perimeter?

- A. 10 feet
- B. 20 feet
- C. 24 feet
- D. 48 feet

Correct Answer: B

Perimeter = $2 \times (6+4) = 20$ feet. Choice A adds the two side lengths ($6+4=10$) but forgets to double the sum for the two pairs of sides. Choice C computes the rug's area ($6 \times 4=24$) instead of its perimeter. Choice D results from doubling the area ($24 \times 2=48$) instead of correctly computing the perimeter.

Question 16 | Data Analysis

A paraeducator recorded how many books each of 5 students read in a month: Ana-4, Ben-6, Cleo-3, Dev-6, Ella-5. What is the median number of books read?

- A. 4
- B. 6
- C. 5
- D. 24

Correct Answer: C

Sorted from least to greatest: 3, 4, 5, 6, 6. The median is the middle value: 5. Choice A results from picking the second-lowest value instead of the true middle value after sorting. Choice B is the mode (6 appears twice), not the median. Choice D is the sum of all five values ($4+6+3+6+5=24$), not the median.

Question 17 | Ratio & Proportion

In a classroom, the ratio of boys to girls is 3 to 5. If there are 12 boys, how many girls are there?

- A. 20
- B. 15
- C. 17

D. 7

Correct Answer: A

The scale factor is $12 \div 3 = 4$, so girls = $5 \times 4 = 20$. Choice B results from adding the boys' ratio number (3) directly to the boy count instead of finding and applying the scale factor: $12 + 3 = 15$. Choice C results from adding the girls' ratio number (5) directly to the boy count instead of scaling proportionally: $12 + 5 = 17$. Choice D results from subtracting the girls' ratio number (5) from the boy count instead of scaling proportionally: $12 - 5 = 7$.

Question 18 | Order of Operations

What is the value of $3 + 2 \times (8 - 5)$?

A. 15

B. 9

C. 14

D. 6

Correct Answer: B

Following order of operations: parentheses first ($8 - 5 = 3$), then multiplication ($2 \times 3 = 6$), then addition ($3 + 6 = 9$). Choice A results from adding 3 and 2 first (5), then multiplying by 3: $5 \times 3 = 15$. Choice C results from ignoring the parentheses and evaluating strictly in the order written: $2 \times 8 = 16$, then $3 + 16 - 5 = 14$. Choice D results from dropping the "3+" term entirely and computing only $2 \times (8 - 5) = 6$.

Question 19 | Diagnosing Student Errors

A student solved $1/4 + 2/4$ and wrote the answer as $3/8$. What error did the student most likely make?

A. The student subtracted instead of added.

B. The student multiplied the two fractions instead of adding them.

C. The student converted the fractions to decimals first.

D. The student added both the numerators and the denominators instead of keeping the denominator the same.

Correct Answer: D

The answer $3/8$ comes exactly from adding the numerators ($1 + 2 = 3$) and the denominators ($4 + 4 = 8$) separately, instead of keeping the common denominator and adding only the numerators (which gives $3/4$). Choice A is incorrect because subtracting the fractions would give $1/4$, not $3/8$. Choice B is incorrect because multiplying the fractions would give $2/16$ ($1/8$), not $3/8$. Choice C is incorrect because converting to decimals and adding would give 0.75, not a value matching $3/8$ (0.375).

Question 20 | Diagnosing Student Errors

A student rounded 452 to the nearest hundred and wrote 400. What error did the student most likely make?

A. The student rounded to the nearest ten instead of the nearest hundred.

B. The student added 100 instead of rounding.

- C. The student rounded down instead of up.
- D. The student rounded to the nearest thousand.

Correct Answer: C

452 is closer to 500 than to 400 (only 48 away from 500, versus 52 away from 400), so the correct rounded value is 500. The student's answer of 400 means they rounded down instead of up. Choice A is incorrect because rounding 452 to the nearest ten gives 450, not 400. Choice B is incorrect because adding 100 to 452 gives 552, not 400. Choice D is incorrect because rounding 452 to the nearest thousand gives 0, not 400.

Writing

Question 21 | Usage

Identify the segment that contains an error. If there is no error, choose “No mistakes.”

- A. The list of supplies
- B. are kept
- C. in the closet.
- D. No mistakes

Correct Answer: B

Segment B contains a subject-verb agreement error. The subject of the sentence is “the list” (singular), and “of supplies” is a prepositional phrase that does not change the subject’s number — so the verb should be “is kept,” not “are kept.” Segment A correctly introduces the singular subject. Segment C is correct. Since segment B contains a genuine error, “No mistakes” is incorrect.

Question 22 | Usage

Identify the segment that contains an error. If there is no error, choose “No mistakes.”

- A. Between you and I,
- B. the assignment was
- C. too difficult to finish in one class period.
- D. No mistakes

Correct Answer: A

Segment A incorrectly uses the subject pronoun “I” as the object of the preposition “between.” Prepositions take object pronouns, so the correct form is “between you and me.” Segment B is correct. Segment C is correct. Since segment A contains a genuine error, “No mistakes” is incorrect.

Question 23 | Punctuation

Identify the segment that contains an error. If there is no error, choose “No mistakes.”

- A. The paraeducator organized the materials by subject
- B. and then labeled each folder clearly,
- C. this made it easier for substitutes to find what they needed.
- D. No mistakes

Correct Answer: C

Segment C creates a comma splice: “...labeled each folder clearly, this made it easier...” joins two independent clauses with only a comma. A semicolon, period, or connecting word (such as “which”) is needed instead. Segment A is correctly constructed. Segment B is correctly punctuated. Since segment C contains the comma-splice error, “No mistakes” is incorrect.

Question 24 | Capitalization

Identify the segment that contains an error. If there is no error, choose “No mistakes.”

- A. The paraeducator met with the principal
- B. on tuesday morning
- C. to discuss the new schedule.
- D. No mistakes

Correct Answer: B

Segment B fails to capitalize “tuesday.” Days of the week are proper nouns and must always be capitalized: “Tuesday.” Segment A is correct — “principal” is used generically here with no name following it, so it should not be capitalized. Segment C is correct. Since segment B contains a genuine error, “No mistakes” is incorrect.

Question 25 | Sentence Structure

Which is the best way to combine these two sentences?

“The paraeducator prepared the materials early. The lesson could start on time.”

- A. The paraeducator prepared the materials early, the lesson could start on time.
- B. The paraeducator prepared the materials early, but the lesson could start on time.
- C. The paraeducator prepared the materials early, and it was the lesson that could start on time.
- D. The paraeducator prepared the materials early so that the lesson could start on time.

Correct Answer: D

Choice D clearly shows the purpose relationship between the two ideas using “so that” — the materials were prepared for the purpose of starting the lesson on time. Choice A creates a comma splice by joining two independent clauses with only a comma. Choice B uses “but,” a contrast word, which misrepresents the relationship — there is no contrast between the two ideas. Choice C is awkward and unnecessarily wordy (“it was the lesson that”), which weakens clarity instead of improving it.

Question 26 | Paragraph Organization

Which sentence does NOT belong in the following paragraph?

“(1) The after-school program offers homework help every day. (2) Students can also join a chess club on Wednesdays. (3) The school's cafeteria serves lunch at noon. (4) On Fridays, there is an art workshop for students who want to draw or paint.”

- A. Sentence 3
- B. Sentence 1
- C. Sentence 2
- D. Sentence 4

Correct Answer: A

Sentences 1, 2, and 4 all describe activities offered by the after-school program, which is the paragraph's topic. Sentence 3, about when the cafeteria serves lunch, is unrelated to the after-school program's activities and breaks the paragraph's focus. Choices B, C, and D are incorrect because those sentences all directly support the paragraph's main topic.

Question 27 | Writing Process

A student has finished writing a first draft of a story. According to the standard writing process, what should the student do next?

- A. Publish the story immediately without any changes.
- B. Begin planning a completely different story.
- C. Revise the draft to improve ideas, organization, and clarity.
- D. Submit the draft directly for a final grade.

Correct Answer: C

In the standard writing process (prewriting, drafting, revising, editing, publishing), revising follows drafting — the writer reviews and improves the draft's content and organization before moving on to editing and publishing. Choice A skips essential steps in the process. Choice B abandons the current piece instead of continuing the process with it. Choice D treats the first draft as a finished product, skipping revision and editing entirely.

Question 28 | Spelling

Identify the segment that contains an error. If there is no error, choose “No mistakes.”

- A. The teacher gave seperate
- B. instructions to each
- C. small group.
- D. No mistakes

Correct Answer: A

Segment A misspells “separate” (correct spelling has an “a” in the middle: s-e-p-a-r-a-t-e, not “seperate”). Segments B and C contain no spelling errors. Because segment A contains a clear spelling error, “No mistakes” is incorrect.

Question 29 | Punctuation

Identify the segment that contains an error. If there is no error, choose “No mistakes.”

- A. After the assembly ended,
- B. the students returned to their classrooms
- C. and continued their lessons.
- D. No mistakes

Correct Answer: D

The sentence is correctly constructed throughout: segment A closes the introductory clause with a comma, segment B is a correctly formed independent clause with proper subject-verb-pronoun agreement (“students... their”), and segment C completes the sentence with a parallel verb phrase joined by “and” without an unnecessary comma. Since no segment contains an error, “No mistakes” is the correct choice.

Question 30 | Instructional Application

A student's paragraph begins: "There are many things about recess. It is fun. Some kids play tag." The teacher wants the student to add a clear topic sentence. Which revision best achieves this?

- A. "There are many things about recess."
- B. "Recess is my favorite part of the school day because of the games we play."
- C. "It is fun."
- D. "Some kids play tag."

Correct Answer: B

Choice B clearly states the paragraph's main idea (recess being enjoyable because of games) and gives the paragraph a clear focus, which is what a topic sentence should do. Choice A is vague — "many things" does not tell the reader what the paragraph is actually about. Choice C and Choice D are supporting details, not topic sentences; they describe specific parts of recess rather than introducing the paragraph's overall focus.